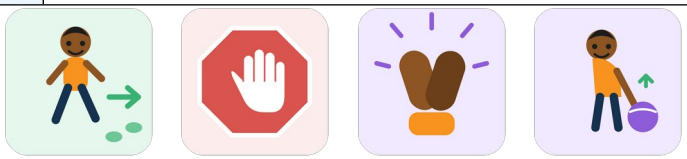
02 · Lesson spec

I Can Give Instructions · 40 minutes · whole class, pairs, then groups · fully unplugged

Goal	**I can give a friend-robot clear commands.**
Core parts	Move + Code
Key words	instruction · command · listen · robot · stop · machine
Materials	Command cards (walk, stop, clap, pick up), one set per pair; a soft toy or ball per group; machine pictures (washing machine, lift, gate); cardboard Ayo; taped floor grid



1. Watch (5 min)

- **Show:** cardboard Ayo. **Say:** “Ayo can only do what he is told. Watch: Go!” Move Ayo somewhere silly.
- **Ask:** “Where did he go? Did ‘Go!’ tell him where?” Then say “Walk two steps. Stop.” and move him exactly. “That was clear!”
- **Show** the machine pictures: “A washing machine, a lift, a gate. They follow instructions too. People tell them what to do. We only press their buttons with a grown-up.”
- **New words with hand signs:** command = point forward · listen = hand cupped at your ear · stop = palm out · robot = stiff robot arms · machine = turn a knob.

2. Do in pairs and groups (25 min)

a) Match the command, whole class (7 min) · Core: Code

- The teacher says a command (“clap!”); children hold up the matching card. Do all four: walk, stop, clap, pick up.
- Then pairs: one child holds up a card **while saying** its command; the partner checks it matches.

b) Robot Says in pairs (8 min) · Core: Move

- The commander gives **2 commands** (“walk 2 steps… clap”). The friend-robot does **only** what is said, then stands still.
- Swap. **Stretch:** give 3 commands in a row.

c) Toy rescue, groups (10 min)

- Put a soft toy a few steps away. The commander gives 2 clear commands to reach it (“walk 3 steps… pick up the teddy”).
- The class shows thumbs up if each command was clear. Swap commander and robot.

3. Share (10 min)

- **Activity Book page** (4 min): circle the “stop” picture; match each command to its picture. Not marked.
- **Ask:** “Which commands were clear? What machine at home does what people tell it?”
- **Create** (if time allows): draw Ayo reaching the toy and the commands you gave.
- **Build** (optional): the child who is Ayo wears a paper robot tag.
- **Close:** “Robots and machines do what we tell them. So we tell them clearly!”

Common mistakes

- Vague commands (“go there”) → ask “How many steps? Which way?”
- The robot does extra things → “Robots only do what they hear. Stand still and wait.”
- Too many commands at once → hold up two fingers: two commands only.

What if it doesn’t work?

- A commander freezes → the teacher whispers a command for them to say.
- No toy → use a shoe, a book or a scrunched paper ball.

Support and stretch

- **Support:** one command at a time; the child holds up the card instead of speaking.
- **Stretch** (optional, never assessed): 3 commands in a row.

How we check

Observation only. Tick each child who **gives a friend-robot 2 clear commands it can follow**. Also note who can **name a machine at home** that does what people tell it.

> **Safety**
> Soft toys only. Walk, never run. On “stop”, robots freeze at once. Machine buttons only with a grown-up.